Would You Cry for Me?

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Would You Cry for Me?

by JustKidd

Summary

SPOP end of S3 canon divergent.
What if instead of Angella, Catra was the one that pulled the sword?

Tags will be updated as we go. Maybe.

Angella

Angella was a coward. When Hordak started the war, she was the first of the Etherians to deny his claim. Then the rest of the world followed. Citing her as inspiration, they rallied behind her, and she had sent them to the frontlines, to their deaths while she cowered in Brightmoon Castle. The Rebellion must not lose their beacon of hope, they had said, and she let them. She played the role so well, she herself started to believe that she was indispensable. That the rebellion would crumble without her. So she stayed behind.

When Micah died, instead of leading her people like she was supposed to, she still stayed behind. This time telling herself that Glimmer would be left alone if she also fell. And as if proving her right, the Rebellion crumbled shortly after. All of the remaining free kingdoms separated from the alliance, closing their borders to each other in an effort to slow down the Horde's advance into their territory.

When Glimmer took it upon herself to reforge the alliance, this time with the actual She-ra in tow, Angella still chose to stay at the back, telling herself Adora would be able to protect Glimmer better without her.

And now, the world was ending.

The world was ending, and she was still staring at the sword, stuck in the rock hovering over her. She had said to Adora that she would take care of this. That Adora didn't need to make any more sacrifices. She had promised herself that she'd be brave and do the right thing for once. After sending Adora away, and leaving herself alone with the sword, thinking back to the life she led, Angella found herself wanting. She wanted more. More choices for her people. Better circumstances for children affected by the war like Adora and Bow. More time with Micah and Glimmer. And she knew, if she hesitated now, there would be nothing left for her people and her children.

Angella sighed, and smiled as she blinked away her tears. She promised herself she'd be brave, just one time. Steeling herself, she took a deep breath and spread her wings wide. She was three inches above the ground when a force on her left shoulder shoved her tumbling to the ground. Rubbing the dizziness from her head, Angella could only stare in horror at the figure glaring at her.

It… she… was covered in a darkness that did not seem to exist. Angella felt like she was looking at a person-shaped hole floating before her that sent shivers down her spine. From the few uncorrupted patches on her body, Angella could tell that she was a Horde soldier. For a moment, Angella glanced at the claw-shaped voids on both of her hands, contemplating if they would be able to cut anything in their current condition, before bringing her eyes back to the figure's face. It was almost completely covered by the void, saved for a few spots on her head, where a flock of thick brown hair was hanging loose. When their eyes met, Angella knew she would never forget the different-coloured eyes that seemed to pierce into hers.

After what seemed like a lifetime to her, the soldier turned her head upwards to look at the sword, which finally broke Angella from her reverie. "The sword! We need to remove it, or we'll be stuck here forever."

"So I heard," the figure spoke. Her voice was low and raspy, with a hint of otherworldly airiness. She then brought her head back to look at Angella. The piercing coldness she felt from her eyes earlier was gone, replaced with some sort of longing… and resentment. Without saying another word, she turned back and started jumping on the smaller rocks floating around the field, making her way towards the sword.

"Wait. What are you doing? If you pull the sword, you will be the one stuck here, alone, forever."

The figure stopped, squatting on one of the floating rocks, with her back still towards her. "And if you think I wouldn't let you martyr yourself here, and give your little Rebellion more reason to

band together against us, you are not as smart as they say." She paused, then continued, "it's better this way. No one would care for a missing soldier after a battle."

"Surely you must have someone—"

She scoffed. "It's a short list, if it ever existed." She stood up again, and was preparing herself for another jump.

"It's always longer than you think."

She stopped, and turned around to face her. Angella gasped. Her face was now completely covered by the void. It even covered one of her eyes, leaving behind an even darker blackness where it used to be, like a hollowed eye socket on a non-existing skull.

"Would *you* cry for me?"

Caught off-guard by the question, Angella stammered. "I… uh… I…"

"I thought not. No tears for the Horde scum, huh?" Angella was about to answer when she cut her off again. "Save it, *your grace*. I'm not doing this for you, I'm doing it for me. I'm just… tired."

With a powerful leapt, the figure jumped, scaling the next two rocks at once and made her way to the sword. In truth, Angella knew that she could probably reach the sword first with her wings, and yet, she could not bear herself to move. Angella was selfish, and a coward after all.

So she watched, as the figure, now smaller than her palm, reached for the sword and everything was covered by a blinding white light.

Adora

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Something had changed since the portal, Adora couldn't tell what, specifically, but she felt it in her bones, as she looked at the destroyed bots and collapsed soldiers before her. She gave Bow a tired smile when he tapped her on the shoulder for the good job they did today. She could hear Mermista's shout in the distance, ordering the soldiers for a headcount and to check the supplies. From the corner of her eyes, she saw Perfuma and Frosta leading the villagers to clear the area.

The Horde seemed to be regressing back to their original strategy of piling bots and soldiers on Brightmoon's borders to overwhelm them instead of the precise positioning that Catra favored. And Catra was nowhere near the frontlines. In the three skirmishes they had since coming back, Adora did not see Catra nor Scorpia once. Without the force captains, the Horde had lost their ability to adapt mid-battle, giving the princesses the edge they needed to push back. And they did. In Catra's absence, the Rebellion had managed to reclaim their territories back from the Horde, one village at a time; a fact that put a smile on Glimmer's face, and made Adora's frown deeper.

Adora knew the Horde's stance on failure; she grew up in it. Catra had failed. Opening the portal probably depleted the Horde's resources for a few months at least. With nothing to show for, that failure would be massive. Hordak had no personal vendetta against Catra like Shadow Weaver did, but Adora still shuddered to think what Hordak would do to her. Now more than ever, Adora needed to see Catra. She needed to know that Catra was safe.

That the Horde would not be as cruel as Weaver. Adora scanned the field one last time, hoping she'd catch a glimpse of Catra in the shadows of the trees, or a scratch mark somewhere. Anything that would tell her of Catra's status. She sighed when she saw Bow giving them the return signal.

The journey back to Brightmoon was uneventful. There was no ambush or traps waiting for them halfway through, or pursuers from behind. Another evidence that Catra was no longer in Hordak's favor. Catra would be lucky if a demotion was all she got. Adora shook her head, trying to get the thought out of her, focusing on the positive side instead. Perhaps now she could finally convince Catra to ditch the Horde and join her at Brightmoon. Of course, she needed to talk to Catra first.

When they arrived, Adora, Bow, and Glimmer went straight to report to the queen, while the other princesses went to organize their supplies and soldiers or tend to the injured villagers they had brought back.

Queen Angella was sitting at the head of the table in the War Room, rubbing her temple as she listened to a report from General Juliette. As soon as she saw them coming in, she motioned for Juliette to stop, and immediately hugged all three of them, despite Glimmer's protest and Bow's assurance. Adora was crushed in the middle.

Adora smiled as she watched Angella fuss over Glimmer, and couldn't help the pang of jealousy in her chest. She remembered how willing was Angella to sacrifice herself if it would mean Glimmer would be safe, how devastated Glimmer looked when Adora told her and Bow what had happened after coming back

from the portal, and how relieved they were when they actually found Angella when they teleported back to Brightmoon Castle. Glimmer was hugging Angella, confessing in between sobs to basically all the time she had gone against the Queen's orders, promising to be better. Angella simply held her tight, not saying a word. Adora never had anyone fussed over her like Angella did Glimmer. Shadow Weaver would come close, in a way that one would be closer to a hundred than a zero. And—

"Something on your mind?"

Adora broke away from her trance and refocused her sight. Angella was smiling at her. "No, nothing in particular. I'm just… I'm really glad you're here, your majesty. I don't know what we would do if you were really left in the portal."

"I know what *I* would do."

"Glimmer, shush." Angella looked back at her, and flashed her a sad smile. "So am I. I just wished I remembered more about what happened. I don't want to keep remembering them as a Horde soldier with one eye for the rest of my life. Not after what they did for us."

"I don't. That's more than they deserve after causing the portal in the first place."

“Glimmer, that’s not very nice. They may be our enemy, but respect should be given where it’s due. That’s what separates us from the Horde.” Glimmer simply crossed her arms and huffed.

Adora had asked Angella what happened after she ordered her to get to safety. Right after coming back, Angella only remembered a shadowy figure had pushed her to the ground and removed the sword. Minor details would come to her in bits and pieces over time, from the conversation they might have had, that they figure could actually be a Horde soldier, and that they had one eye. Adora only knew one Horde soldier with one eye, and she didn’t think Octavia would sacrifice herself for anyone, much less for a member of the Rebellion. Not willingly, at least.

Adora was about to ask Angella if she remembered something new, when she felt the chill on her spine. Angella’s face contorted into a deep frown, while Glimmer tried to maintain a straight face. She and Bow turned around to find Shadow Weaver standing at the door, sandwiched between two Brightmoon soldiers, acting like they were her escorts.

“What is the meaning of this? My order was clear! She is not to leave the room until we can decide what to do with her.” The soldier on the left flinched at Angella’s harsh tone. The one on the right opened her mouth but no words came out.

“Your Majesty,” Shadow Weaver said, with the usual lilt in her voice, that made Adora shudder. She knew the tone well. “I can assure you, I mean you no harm. I am here simply to offer my service should you need it. A consult, if you will.”Still standing straight where she was, she then looked at Glimmer. Angella moved in front of Glimmer, glaring at her. “I believe a

congratulation is in order. The princess campaign against the Horde seems to be moving smoothly. Of course, the current Horde is not in the same caliber it used to be." Seeing the frown slowly forming on Glimmer, Shadow Weaver slowly bowed. "I am sorry if I offended you, Your Highness. That was out of line. But I can assure you, it is still an impressive feat."

"Is that all?"

"Your Majesty, as I was saying, I am here to offer a consult, for your consideration. Nothing more." She paused, and looked around the room. Adora felt her breath lodged in her throat as she made eye contact with her. "With the Horde being successfully pushed back, perhaps it is time for Brightmoon to go on the offensive? I can assure you, the Horde still has not made full recovery after opening the portal. With them losing more and more territories everyday, it is the right time for us to finish this war, once and for all."

"And what resources are you suggesting we use for this? Whose soldiers to send in this suggestion of yours?"

Shadow Weaver tilted her head, looked again at Adora, before turning back to face Angella. "Your Majesty, Brightmoon now has the Horde's former second-in-command and a former force captain in her ranks. Between me and Adora, there is nothing we do not know about the Fright Zone. We can device the most effective strategy to break through their defense, and finish this with minimum casualties."

Angella kept glaring at Shadow Weaver after her long speech. She closed her eyes, and let the pregnant silence lingered in the room. She sucked in a deep breath, and released it, before opening her eyes. “Let’s get one thing clear, Shadow Weaver. You are not a guest here. You are Brightmoon’s prisoner. A willing one, but a prisoner still.We will treat you with the same treatment as other prisoners, whether you deserve it or not, but nothing more. The next time you speak out of line, I will personally escort you to Mystacor myself.”

Adora let out a breath she didn’t know she was holding at Angella’s words. This time, it was Shadow Weaver’s turn to glare at Angella, but the Queen simply ignored her. “General Juliette. Please escort the prisoner back to her room. And I expect these two will be appropriately punished for this failure.” The soldiers on Shadow Weaver’s sides flinched at Angella’s commanding tone, but kept their backs straight. “And make sure they receive additional training against manipulation tactics, magical and otherwise.”

Juliette gave them a salute, and motioned for the soldiers to follow her. Angella was still glaring at the door when all four were out of sight. She sighed wearily, and flashed a tired smile to Adora. “I know you’re supposed to brief me, but do you mind if we move it later? It has been a long day.”

Adora was about to answer, when Glimmer teleported right beside her and put her arms on her and Bow’s shoulder. “Of course, we’ll just let you rest. In fact, why don’t we just skip today’s briefing? There’s nothing new to report anyway.” She flashed her a reassuring smile when Angella raised an eyebrow at her. “You look tired. You should get some rest. We’ll go get some rest too. Love you, see you, bye.”

“Glimm—”

Adora did not hear Angella finish what she had to say before Glimmer teleported them back to her room.

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“I can’t believe I let you talk me into this,” Adora said, as she looked at the silhouette of the Fright Zone. She turned back to look at Glimmer, who just gave her a shrug, so she turned and glared at Bow instead. “And you, you’re supposed to be the voice of reason. You should be the one convincing us this is a bad idea.” Bow opened his mouth to say something, but stopped and raised his palms in defeat. Two days had passed since the encounter with Shadow Weaver. After teleporting them back to her room, Glimmer, predictably, decided that they should follow Shadow Weaver’s suggestion. Adora protested, as much as she could. She had asked Bow’s opinion, relying on his rational thinking to not go against Angella’s order, but he suggested the three of them should go to Fright Zone and try to convince Entrapta to join the Rebellion again. Seeing that the bots made the majority of the Horde’s attackers nowadays, he reasoned that if they were successful, they would be able to cut the Horde’s force in half, which would practically guarantee the Rebellion’s victory. And slipping in and out of the Fright Zone would be less risky with just the three of them. Outnumbered, Adora reluctantly agreed. They had to wait for a few days not to alert Angella, which brought them to today, after they were able to convince her to let them go on a recon mission. Adora sighed, and looked at Bow and Glimmer. “Let’s go.”

Sneaking into the Fright Zone was easier than the last time. There were barely any living guards, and most of the patrols were assigned to bots now, with set routes that were easy to predict. Adora was trying to decide the most possible place for Entrapta to be, when she caught sight of the corridor that led to the prison area. She knew she lingered for too long at the direction when she felt a hand on her shoulder. Glimmer was staring at her, and slowly shook her head. Adora huffed, and continued to check the area, when she saw Scorpia from the corner of her eyes. She pointed in the direction with a slight jab of her head. Bow and Glimmer nodded, and they sneaked their way towards her.

Scorpia was holding a box filled with scraps of some kind, wires and broken parts jutting out of the exposed top. She paced slowly through the corridor, stopping twice to place the box on the floor to catch her breath and stretch her back. She turned around the corner a few times before finally stopping in front of the door, scanned her badge, and went in.

Not wanting the door to close and lock on them, Adora rushed in, followed by Glimmer and Bow. Scorpia yelped and dropped the box, spilling the contents on the floor. She stared at the parts for a moment, glared at them, before squatting down and picking the parts and placing them back in the box. "What are you doing here? You shouldn't be here." She placed the box on a table and sat on the chair nearby.

"Where is Catra?" Adora heard Glimmer groan beside her, but she just couldn't take it any longer. She needed to know. Scorpia didn't answer, and looked at her instead. Scorpia seemed to have lost her cheerful self in the portal. She was scowling. There were large bags under her eyes, which were red and puffy, like she had

been crying for the past few days. Scorpia seemed to have aged herself by a few years in weeks.

"She's not here." Her answer was short, and devoid of any emotion. Adora was about to ask more, when she was cut by Glimmer.

"What do you mean she's not here? Where is she? What is she planning now? I swear, if—"

"She didn't come back." A muffled voice from the ceiling cut Glimmer's words short, but Adora swore that was what it sounded like. She looked at the spot on the ceiling, and followed the ruffling sound to the back of the room, where Entrapta dropped down from a vent on the wall. She dusted herself off, and picked a broken part from the floor.

"Wh- what do you mean she didn't come back. Where did she go?"

Entrapta looked at her like she had grown a second head. Like the answer was so obvious to everyone but Adora. Still, Adora had to ask. Entrapta raised her goggles and placed them on her head. It wasn't as bad as Scorpia, but Adora could see the slight darkness under her eyes, and the redness in them. "From the portal. Catra never came back."

Adora’s world turned dark. Her words stuck in her throat, refusing to get out. This was a joke. A prank, like Catra always played on her. Any moment now, Catra would rush out from somewhere, and they would make up and be friends again. Or she would come out of hiding and attack her, so Adora had to fight back. They would still be enemies, but they would be in a world where Catra was in it. Adora turned her head around, scanning the room for signs of a hiding spot, until her eyes met with Scorpia. Adora kept staring at her. If someone would know where Catra was, it was Scorpia.

“Think better of her, Adora. She’s not as bad as you think.” Scorpia raised both of her arms, and tapped both of her pincers a few times. “Meeting Wildcat was the best thing that has ever happened to me. She saw me for what I am, not the failures of my family.”

Glimmer scoffed. “Not as bad as we think. Yeah, right. She attacked Brightmoon! She’s evil.”

Scorpia’s face hardened at Glimmer’s retort. “The Horde attacked Brightmoon. I know, I was there. Wildcat led us because she was the best person for the job. Just like the three of you are the best person for sneaking into the Fright Zone undetected.” She turned to look back at Adora. “What are you doing here, Adora? The Horde is done. You know it. The princesses know it. Even the soldiers know it. Just ask the Queen to offer a term for surrender, and someone’s bound to take it. Hordak won’t even care cause he’s been locking himself in his lab ever since the portal. You won. Congratulations.”

Adora couldn't form any words. She heard what Scorpia said, but she could not understand the meaning. Catra never came back. Entrapta's words kept repeating over and over in her head.

Catra never came back.

Catra never came back.

Catra never came back.

…

…

…

Hey, Adora.

Six months after finding the Sword of Power, Adora found herself back in a dark and dusty room in the Fright Zone. Surrounded by friends and enemies, Adora curled herself into a ball and cried.

Chapter End Notes

Adora probably would, right?

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